

Prompting Techniques:

1) Zero Shot

Simply giving the model the instructions without any examples.

When to use: When the task is simple or model understands the domain well.

Use cases: Classification, Simple QA & summarization

2) One shot

You provide only one example before asking the question

When to use: When you want your answer to be in specific structure

Use cases: Email templating, structure output

3) Few shot

provide 3-10 examples, showing the model how to behave.

When to use: when task has nuanced patterns, consistency matters

Use cases: Sentimental analysis, Role based writing, Grammar Transformations

4) Multi shot

provide large number of examples with the prompt.

When to use: When you want your model to learn from many demonstrations

when you want to train model to near level consistency without finetuning.

Use cases: Long, complex transformations

Instruction following tasks wants more samples.

5.) Chain of Thought (CoT) prompting:

Ask the model to think step by step to improve reasoning.

When to use: Complex task, math/logic solving, Multihop questions.

Use case: Root cause analysis, fraud analysis, Math problems

Note: CoT increases accuracy but reduces latency and may overexplain if not controlled.

6.) Self Consistency Prompting:

Generate multiple reasoning paths & choose the best one.

When to use: When correctness is important than speed
Tasks with multiple reasoning paths.

Use case: Decision Making, Puzzle Solving

Note: x

7.) ReAct Prompting (Reason + Act)

Blends thoughts (reasoning) and Action (tool)

When to use: agent like behavior needed

Use case: Agents, multitool workflow, RAG + reasoning

(8) Retrieval Augmented Prompting:

Injecting external retrieval context to the prompt.

(9) Role Prompting:

Assigning a role to shape tone, behaviour & constraints

Use Case: Customer support bots, expert assistants

When to use: When a domain expert style is answering

(10) Instruction Prompting:

Using direct commands like "Do x, then y and then z"

When to use: reduce ambiguity, build deterministic pipelines

use cases: Classification, extraction, policy enforcement

(11) Deliberate Prompting:

Ask the model to generate multiple candidate solutions internally and choose one

When to use: High stake tasks, Tasks requiring multiple evaluation options

use case: Strategic decision prompts, creative tasks, product planning.

(12) Thought Suppression Prompting:

Instruct the model not to reveal reasoning (No CoT)

Use case: Correctness needed with CoT but hidden.
Production grade user facing systems.

13.) Guardrail Prompting

Explicitly constraint what model can do and ~~not~~ ^{cannot} do.

When to use: Safety sensitivity tasks, compliance heavy domains

Use case: Finance, medical, legal.
preventing hallucinations, bias, toxicity.

14.) Program Aided Prompting:

The model writes code/tools and execute^{them} for reasoning¹

When to use: When correctness > language fluency
When numeric precision is needed.

Use case: Math, Data transformations. API calling agents.